25.4.3 Managing your local JWTs

When you're generating a JWT, the user-jwts tool automatically saves the JWT configuration (the JSON shown in section 25.4.2) to your hard drive. This is stored next to the secrets.json file that contains the User Secrets, in a location that varies depending on your operating system and the `<UserSecretsId>` in your project file:

- *Windows*—%APPDATA%\Microsoft\UserSecrets\<UserSecretsId>\user-jwts.json
- *Linux and macOS*—~/.microsoft/usersecrets/<UserSecretsId>/user-jwts.json

As for User Secrets, JWTs created by user-jwts aren't encrypted, but they're outside your project directory, so they are a better approach to managing secrets locally. The generated JWTs should be used only for local testing; you should be using a real identity provider for production systems to securely produce JWTs for a logged-in user. This is the reason why the user-jwts tool updates only appsettings.Development.json with the required configuration, not appsettings.json; it stops you from accidentally using user-jwts in production. You should add your production identity provider details in appsettings.json instead.

As well as editing the user-jwts.json file manually, you can use the user-jwts tool to manage the JWTs stored locally. In addition to using `create`, you can call `dotnet user-jwts <command>` from the project folder, where `<command>` is one of the following options:

- `list`—Lists a summary of all the tokens stored in user-jwts.json for the project.